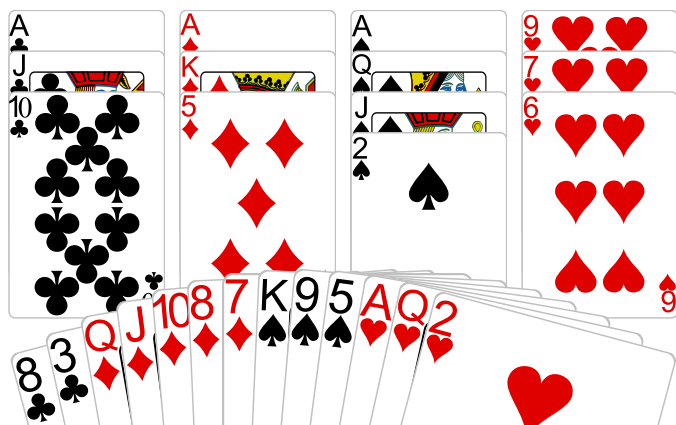
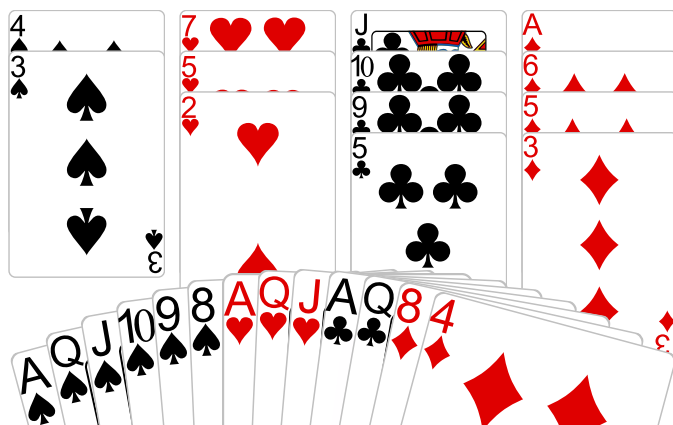


Deal 1 Ctr: 6NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 3 Ctr: 4♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 4
♥ J 10 5 4
♦ 9 4 3
♣ K 7 5 2

♠ K 9 5
♥ A Q 2
♦ Q J 10 8 7
♣ 8 3



♠ 10 8 7 3
♥ K 8 3
♦ 6 2
♣ Q 9 6 4

♠ A Q J 2
♥ 9 7 6
♦ A K 5
♣ A J 10

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			

6NT by North

DO NOT FINESSE THE ♥. Stick with your original 75% plan. Take the ♥A and play your small ♣, finessing the ♣J. This is why you couldn't discard a ♣ earlier.

The single ♥ finesse is an inferior play because its success depends on West holding a specific card, the ♥K.

The double ♣ finesse is much better because its success depends on East holding either of two cards, the ♣Q **OR** the ♣K.

North is to play 6NT. East leads the ♠3.

Winners: ♠=4 ♥=1 ♦=5 ♣=1 Total = 11

You need one more winner from the ♥ or ♣ suit. The straight finesse of the ♥K offers a 50% chance of success. The double finesse of the ♣ K Q offers a 75% chance of success. It's a no-brainer. Run 4 ♠s and 5 ♦s ending in your hand. Be very careful not to discard a ♣ from your hand.

[showcards N:H9,CA,CJ,CT S:HA,HQ,C8,C3]

Lead a small ♣ and play the ♣10 if East plays low. Let's say West wins the ♣K and returns a ♥.

[showcards N:H9,CA,CJ S:HA,HQ,C8]

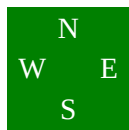
Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 4 3
 ♥ 7 5 2
 ♦ A 6 5 3
 ♣ J 10 9 5

♠ K 7 2
 ♥ K 9 6 4
 ♦ 9 2
 ♣ K 7 6 3



♠ A Q J 10 9 8
 ♥ A Q J
 ♦ 8 4
 ♣ A Q

♠ 6 5
 ♥ 10 8 3
 ♦ K Q J 10 7
 ♣ 8 4 2

West	North	East	South
		2 ♣	Pass
2 ♦	Pass	2 ♠	Pass
2NT	Pass	4 ♠	
All Pass			

4 ♠ by East
surely still have a ♥ loser. But if you finesse the ♣K successfully you will eliminate your ♣ loser.

East is to play 4 ♠. South leads the ♦ K.

Losers: ♠=1 ♥=1 ♦=1 ♣=1 Total = 4

South has made another great lead. Any other suit would have given you a free finesse. You should duck the first ♦. It is very possible that South has led from ♦ K Q 10 and will be afraid to continue for fear you have the ♦ J in your hand. You'd be very happy to see him switch to any other suit. But he doesn't, he continues with the ♦ Q which you take with dummy's ♦ A.

You are in dummy for the first, last, and only time. You need to try a finesse right now, but which one? At first you might think it makes no difference but, in fact, there is only one reasonable choice. If you finesse the ♠K successfully you may still have a ♠ loser. If you finesse the ♥K successfully you will

What a great layout! Three possible finesses and every one of them would work.

But as you can see, only the ♣ finesse will actually save you a trick.